6.4.4 Setting-up governance team operations

Here we present steps for governance implementation, as presented by the Business Application Research Center (BARC):

1. *Define goals and understand the benefits*. This step is critical from the perspective of being able to convince the appropriate stakeholders. The alignment of project and enterprise strategic goals is key to successfully implementing data governance in the enterprise.
2. *Analyze the current state and delta analysis.* This is another critical element of communication. The viability of the benefits resulting from governance solutions results from comparing the expected and current situations.
3. *Derive a roadmap.* This is another method of building the proposed solution's viability and a prerequisite of expectation management.
4. *Convince stakeholders and plan the project budget.* This is a must-have. Focusing on the benefits and viability of the solution usually works best. From the business perspective, the properties of the solution are not necessary. As we mentioned, sometimes iron-fisted single-person governance may be the optimal solution for the company. Neither decentralization, not achieving FAIR, nor even increased data connectivity may be convincing enough. The choice should become evident if you connect these effects to business value.
5. *Develop and plan the data governance program.* This is what we're helping you with in this chapter. First, you need to have a clear vision of how things should look before putting things into motion, from the organizational structure to the division of responsibilities.
6. *Implement the data governance program.* This is the hard work. Fortunately, as with all data mesh elements, this work is not only yours. Federated data governance is a team effort.
7. *Monitor and control.* In this critical yet often overlooked element, the data governance council, or its equivalent, should decide on quality metrics early and ensure their implementation. Business feedback is vital as an element of the second line of progress control.